

Welcome to the 2009 PCaP Newsletter



The Department of Defense Prostate Cancer Research Program funded PCaP with over \$14 million. Recently, the American Cancer Society gave us funds to follow-up with our PCaP participants in North Carolina. We want to thank you for being part of PCaP, and we hope that you will continue to take part in our follow-up interviews.

Why is the PCaP study important?

Prostate cancer:

- Is the number one cancer among men, except for skin cancer.
- Is more common in African Americans, and they are more likely to die from their prostate cancer than Caucasians.
- Can grow very slowly in some men, but it can lead to death in other men.

→ We want to know why.

When you found out that you had prostate cancer, most of you had to make some serious decisions. We believe that learning more about what you've been through will help us find ways to improve the lives and health care of men like you.

What have we done so far?

In the first PCaP study visit:

- The PCaP nurse came to your house.
- You gave us samples and information about your prostate cancer and life.

In North Carolina:

- 1032 men completed the in-home visit.
- We finished those in December 2007.

In Louisiana:

- 214 men completed the in-home visit before Hurricane Katrina.
- Then our PCaP team had to start over.
- At the end of August 2009, on the 4th anniversary of Hurricane Katrina, they finished their in-home visits with 1018 more men.

Now that Louisiana is done, we will be able to look more closely at the information you gave us at the in-home visit. Looking at the two states together will help us know why prostate cancer can be so different among men.

We have been able to take one look at some of the differences in men with prostate cancer. A paper describing these results will be published this fall in the journal *Cancer*. We found that having a prostate cancer screening test (a PSA or DRE before there were any signs of prostate cancer) was more likely in men who usually saw the same doctor for regular care.



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We know there are a lot more questions about prostate cancer. Here are some of the other questions we will study.

- Why do people get prostate cancer?
- Are there genes that can lead to prostate cancer?
- Can a man's diet and exercise influence how likely he is to get prostate cancer?
- What makes it more severe in some men than in others?
- Are there different kinds of prostate cancer cells?
- What is the best way to treat it so that men can stay cancer-free and lead a healthy, active life?



New N.C. Cancer Hospital

We want to know the answers to these questions too, and we believe that our studies will have important findings. Over the next several years, we will be able to publish more articles that will help us to better understand prostate cancer. With your help, we believe that we can improve the lives and health of men in the future.

What are we doing now?

Many of you in North Carolina agreed to do our follow-up interviews. We have finished the first year of follow-up, and now we are calling people for the second year.



When our nurses saw you at the first PCaP visit, we asked you questions that might help us figure out why some men are more likely to get severe prostate cancer. These are the questions that we'll look at when Louisiana finishes their in-home visits.

We also asked you a few questions about treatment, but some of you had just found out about your prostate cancer. That meant that some of you had just finished your treatment, while some of you hadn't had the time to decide what to do yet. We know there isn't one perfect treatment to cure prostate cancer yet. Some men are happy with the treatment they get, and some men have lots of problems with side effects.

Therefore, the main goal of this part of the PCaP study is to look at quality of life and treatment in men who have had prostate cancer. Most of you were faced with the big question:

- How can I deal with my cancer without giving up my quality of life? We want to know what you decided to do, how you made that choice, and how you have been since then. We hope that this can help other men in the future.

Prostate cancer can be one of the slowest growing of all cancers, but all of you had to decide what to do about your cancer. Do I want to have treatment, or not? What kind of treatment should I get? Which doctor should I go to?



Many things can influence this decision:

- side effects of treatment
- insurance and money
- trust in your doctors
- support from friends and family

We want to find out more about:

- how you decided what to do
- your quality of life since you found out you had prostate cancer

Many factors can affect your quality of life – for example, urine, bowel, and sexual function. Prostate cancer can affect men in different ways, both physically and emotionally. These are very personal things that can be hard to talk about, but they can be very real side effects of prostate cancer and prostate cancer treatment.

Learning more about these things may give us a better idea of how to help men in the future.

What are our plans for the future?

There is so much more about prostate cancer that we need to learn. For example:

- What are the long term effects of prostate cancer treatment?
- Are some treatments doing a better job at keeping the cancer from spreading or coming back?
- What are the effects of prostate cancer on a man's wife or partner and family?
- How can diet and exercise impact prostate cancer?

Like you, many researchers want to know more about prostate cancer. We will do our best to get more research money to keep studying prostate cancer.

We will also stay in touch with you over the next few years so that you can help us answer these important questions.



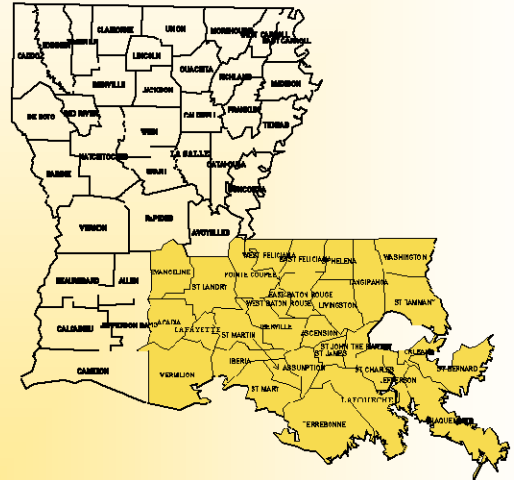
PCaP in Louisiana

Like you, men from Louisiana with prostate cancer are part of the PCaP study. We wanted to study men from both Louisiana and North Carolina because men in these 2 states, especially African American men, have different rates of getting prostate cancer in general and of getting severe prostate cancer.

Because of Hurricane Katrina, Louisiana has just finished the first part of the study, where they interview men in their homes. Now that they are done, our study includes over 2,200 men.

The effects of Hurricane Katrina are still part of the lives of the people who work for PCaP in Louisiana, the men in our study there, and others who live in that state. Many people have not been able to re-build their homes or offices. Some doctors and hospitals have not re-opened. Sometimes they still have problems with the mail and other things that we can take for granted.

LA PCaP Parishes



Last year, the Louisiana PCaP staff was able to move into their new offices. Liz Laney, the NC project manager, and Katie Allman, the NC nurse, went to visit them in New Orleans in October 2008. They got to see first-hand the obstacles that had to be overcome to move forward with the study. We are so thankful to the Louisiana staff and prostate cancer survivors for their hard work and willingness to continue the PCaP study.

North Carolina PCaP Staff

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NC PCaP Counties

